



AUGUST 24-30, 2026

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SONG 65 Move Ahead!

Benefit From the Field Service Group Arrangement

“I will praise Jehovah with all my heart in the assembled group of upright ones.”—[PS. 111:1](#).

FOCUS

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role in helping us to fulfill our commission to preach the good news of the Kingdom “in all the inhabited earth.”—[Matt. 24:14](#).

² How do you feel about the field service group arrangement? A sister named Wendy* says: “So much of my ministry has been shaped by this arrangement. I have learned new preaching and teaching skills from others, have been helped to set and reach spiritual goals, and have made lifelong friends—all as a result of this loving arrangement.” A brother named Rich adds: “I view serving as a group overseer as an outstanding privilege. While some publishers get to assist a person to progress to baptism, a group overseer has unique opportunities to help that person to make spiritual progress for years to come.” A sister named Dinah says: “The field service group arrangement is wonderful! I view my group as my family.”

3. What will we discuss in this article?

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⁴ A field service group overseer is an elder [#] who has been assigned by the body of elders to assist a group of publishers to make spiritual advancement. How does he do this? First, ***he takes an active interest in each person assigned to his group.*** ([Prov. 27:23](#)) Being an alert, caring shepherd, he keeps in contact with them. Doing so helps him to provide spiritual encouragement, emotional support, and practical help. ([Prov. 12:25](#); [Isa. 32:2](#); [Jas. 2:15-17](#)) Second, ***he helps each publisher to have a full share in the ministry.*** He takes a zealous lead in the ministry, especially on weekends. He also works regularly with each publisher to provide personal encouragement and training. If on the rare occasion he cannot be in service, he makes sure that the group is cared for by his assistant or another qualified publisher. Third, ***he helps baptized brothers to qualify for congregation responsibilities.*** ([1 Tim. 3:1](#)) He provides sincere commendation, Scriptural counsel, and regular training to help brothers qualify as ministerial servants and as elders. In view of the importance of the group overseer's role, the body of elders selects those elders who are

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- Shepherd all in the group regularly. Effective shepherding calls may be made at the homes of the publishers, at the Kingdom Hall, or at other appropriate locations. Shepherding may also be provided by telephone or by letter.
- Train brothers to reach their full potential and to help them qualify for increased responsibility.
- Take the lead in your service group even when your group needs to meet together with other service groups.

5. What challenges do some group overseers face?

⁵ A group overseer may face challenges as he cares for those in his group. Consider Jörg, a group overseer from Germany who, like many

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⁶ When possible, field service groups should be kept relatively small so that group overseers can become well-acquainted with all in the group and help them remain spiritually strong. What if there are few elders in the congregation? Rather than make groups so large that a group overseer can no longer fulfill all the aspects of his role, the body of elders may temporarily assign a ministerial servant to care for a group. When groups are relatively small, group overseers are better able to care for the most important aspect of their assignment—their brothers and sisters.

⁷ In congregations with few elders, what can group overseers do to ensure that all in the group are well cared for? ([1 Peter 5:2](#)) (See also picture.)

⁷ If you serve as a group overseer in a congregation with few elders,

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An elder may train a ministerial servant in the service group, such as asking him to conduct a meeting for service (See paragraph 7)

CONTRIBUTE TO THE SUCCESS

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not speak with your group overseer? He may be able to make arrangements for you to tie in to the group by means of videoconference and to engage in letter writing or phone witnessing. Are you young and in good health but still find it hard to get out in service regularly? If so, why not plan to work in person with someone in your group each week? You may need to reassess your priorities or adjust the way you manage your time. ([Rom. 12:11; Col. 4:5](#)) Every effort is worth it. Pray to Jehovah. He can give you “both the desire and the power to act.”—[Phil. 2:13](#).

9. How might we contribute to a warm, loving atmosphere in our field service group? ([Romans 12:13](#))

⁹ ***Be hospitable.*** We contribute to a warm, loving atmosphere within our field service group by following “the course of hospitality.” (**Read [Romans 12:13](#).**) Might we be able to make our home available as a

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¹⁰ Take the initiative. The more skillful we are in preaching and teaching, the more likely we are to enjoy going in service with our group. Is there an aspect of your ministry that you would like to improve? Why not take the initiative to ask someone—perhaps a pioneer or an experienced publisher in your group—for help? (**Read [Proverbs 1:5; 27:17.](#)**) Let your group overseer know about your goal. ¹⁸ He may be able to help you reach it. You might also ask others for help. A sister named Heather did that. Although shy, she says: “I asked a pioneer for help in making return visits. She was loving and kind, and she made regular arrangements to work with me. She even helped me start a Bible study with one of my return visits. I am so glad that I asked for help because I now enjoy being out in the ministry again.” Clearly, we can contribute to the success of our field service group in many ways.

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The small size of a field service group allows us to get to know others and to share in the ministry with them (See paragraph 10)

HOW YOU CAN BENEFIT FROM YOUR FIELD SERVICE GROUP

11-12. What spiritual benefits can you receive from the field service group arrangement? Relate an experience.

¹¹ *Spiritual benefits.* Each of us can benefit spiritually from the field service group arrangement. For example, those whom Jehovah is especially fond of—widows, orphans, and the elderly—receive timely and encouraging shepherding. ([1 Thess. 2:8](#); [Jas. 1:27](#)) We also receive much-needed training in various aspects of the Kingdom preaching and teaching work. Exemplary baptized brothers receive help to

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¹³ Emotional benefits. We form close bonds with those in our group as we work “side by side” with them in the ministry. ([Phil. 1:27](#)) The small size of the field service group may also make it easier for those who are shy or who feel anxious in large crowds to develop close friendships. ([2 Cor. 6:13](#)) We can count on these friends for support during difficult times, such as when we are ill, feeling depressed, or grieving the death of a loved one. ([1 Thess. 5:14](#)) No doubt we will need good friends to a greater extent in the future. ([Matt. 24:21](#)) Our problems may not go away, but they can be more manageable when we know we can count on brothers and sisters who love and support us.—[Prov. 17:17](#).

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14. How do we benefit from our field service group during times of disaster or emergency?

14 *Practical benefits.* We receive timely help from our field service group during disease outbreaks, natural disasters, medical emergencies, persecution, and financial crises. For example, in each congregation, the Congregation Service Committee, along with group overseers, develops a plan to help those with special needs. Group overseers take the lead in locating each family in their field service group and assessing the immediate needs, including medical care, food, water, shelter, and clothing so that relief aid can be provided. What practical help and loving care we receive from our field service group!

15. What unites all of us in Jehovah's organization?

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- How do the group overseer and his assistant care for those assigned to their field service group?

- What can we do to contribute to the success of our field service group?

- What benefits can we receive from the field service group arrangement?

SONG 61 Forward, You Witnesses!

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